

1. Place branding: where do we stand?

Mihalis Kavaratzis and Gregory Ashworth

The overall aim of this book is to examine and clarify several aspects of the recently popularized concept of place branding. Many of the constituents of the application of branding to places, such as identities, image, promotion or sense of place, have been around for a long time. However, the need to analyse their nature in the context of branding and to examine their relationships in detail has grown rapidly in the last decade or so, as places all over the world have put branding activities higher than ever in their agenda. Many controversies, confusions and discords will be discussed in the chapters that follow. This introductory chapter examines contemporary place branding understanding in the literature and describes how the issues discussed in the chapters of this book relate to the general topic and to each other. To start with, it is worth taking a brief look at the wider setting of place marketing.

BEFORE PLACE BRANDING

The application of marketing techniques and the adoption of a marketing philosophy in order to meet operational and strategic goals of places have been well established both in practice and in theory. The rapid rise in popularity of place marketing over the past decade, to the extent that it has become an acceptable and commonplace activity of place management, may give the impression that this is a recent phenomenon. It is not. Places have long felt a need to differentiate themselves from each other in order to assert their individuality and distinctive characteristics in pursuit of various economic, political or socio-psychological objectives. The conscious attempt of governments to shape a specifically designed place identity and promote it to identified markets, whether external or internal, is almost as old as government itself. The phenomenon of places transferring marketing knowledge to their own operational needs is not as novel as one might think. As Ashworth and Voogd (1994:39) describe: 'since Leif Ericson sought new settlers in the 8th century for his newly

discovered “green” land, the idea of the deliberate projection of favourable place images to potential customers, investors or residents has been actively pursued’. Thus, any consideration of the fundamental geographical idea of sense of place must include the deliberate creation of such senses through place marketing. However, the way it has been used, the instruments available, the active agencies, and the goals pursued have all evolved as a result of sets of changes in both the marketing and planning disciplines as described below. The transfer of marketing knowledge to the operational environment of cities has caused difficulties and misalignments, which could be attributed to several reasons, all of which are related to the peculiar nature of places as marketable assets. Several ways in which marketing has been related to places have been identified (Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2008). Despite the accumulated experience, significant issues surrounding the application of place marketing remain in need of further practical clarification as well as clearer theoretical development. Indeed, as Skinner’s (2008) comprehensive review of the literature has concluded, place marketing is suffering from a ‘confused identity’, which stems, along with other factors, from the different subject areas and professional interests of the various commentators (Skinner, 2008).

It is accepted here that place marketing can be treated as an instrument of place management undertaken in pursuit of objectives that relate to the management of the place (Ashworth and Voogd, 1990a). At its simplest level, it is merely the recognition that places exist within competitive markets, even if these are difficult to delimit. Places compete with each other and always have done because there are always alternative places that could be selected for any particular use. Place marketing not only recognizes the existence of competition: it also responds by discovering or creating uniqueness in order to improve the competitive position of the place marketed. However, it is important not to equate the stimulation of identity, and thus identification, with place marketing. The former is certainly a part, and usually an important initial condition, of the latter; it does not however encompass it. The identification of people with places is more than place marketing, and place marketing is more than the creation and promotion of place images as part of place management.

The concordance of a number of commentators (including Barke, 1999; Kavaratzis, 2007; Braun, 2008) suggests that the practice of place marketing has developed through discrete phases over time; phases that differ in the general approach towards marketing as well as their level of refinement. These can be grouped into three broadly delimited stages which have not followed a strict timeline, nor have involved geographical distinctiveness. The progress from one stage to the next was more a result of growing understanding and experience of the application of marketing.

Also, each stage was not superseded by the next but rather coexisted so that at any one time a number of these stages can be found, often even in the same place (for a detailed description see Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2008). The first stage has been the stage of place promotion or place boosterism as described in the many historical cases in Gold and Ward (1994). Then came the stage of place marketing as a planning instrument. Place marketing came of age due to changes in both marketing and planning independently that led to a convergence. Place marketing in planning was made possible, by a series of conceptual and practical developments within marketing over the past 40 years. In particular, three necessary precursors to place marketing were the emergence of 'social marketing', 'non-profit marketing' and 'strategic image marketing'. It was changes in the priorities of planning that made place marketing desirable. These changes related to new competitive arenas in which places now operate and to the way society organizes itself (particularly the relationship between government and the governed). Furthermore, these changes concerned the way places are viewed and experienced, and thus the expectations that people hold of places and their managers. The third stage is that of place branding as a distinct focus within place marketing again resulting from a merge between interests of planning and developments in marketing. Particularly, the advent of the concept of corporate branding, which appears to mesh well with the general idea of 'communicative planning', which involves will-shaping, identity forming, and consensus creation.

In practice what was first adopted was the implementation of purely promotional activities, undertaken by several independent actors with an interest in promoting the place (selling what we have). The adoption of marketing alongside other techniques within place management planning in the collective interest was as much a reaction to a crisis of confidence within planning, and perhaps within public service provision in general, that shifted the attention on to finding out what potential consumers or citizens wished to buy or experience (Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2008). Finally, we arrive at a hopefully more refined and clearly targeted place marketing and branding of the future in which the creation of new forms of representation of places and major concerns over the image of the place emphasize distinctiveness transcending mere advertising. It is the latter that is examined in this book, accepting that it is possible to use branding tools and to adopt a branding philosophy for managing places and, at the same time, it is necessary to adapt concepts methods and tools to the specific conditions and characteristics of places. In other words, the contention of this book is that place branding will be legitimate only if it is developed as a distinct form of branding within a framework that applies

specifically to places. There have been such attempts in the past, albeit fragmented, and the chapters in this book signify a new attempt.

PLACE BRANDING IN THE LITERATURE

In general terms, branding is a process which attempts to influence how consumers interpret and develop their own sense of what a brand means and ‘... a brand is a product or service made distinctive by its positioning relative to the competition and by its personality, which comprises a unique combination of functional attributes and symbolic values’ (Hankinson and Cowking, 1993:10). A brand embodies a whole set of physical and socio-psychological attributes and beliefs which are associated with the product (Simoes and Dibb, 2001). Branding is a deliberate process of selecting and associating these attributes because they are assumed to add value to the basic product or service (Knox and Bickerton, 2003). Place branding attempts to transfer those meanings to the operational environment of place management and it centres around the conceptualization of a specific place as a brand. That means that for the purposes of branding the place, whether a country, a region, a city or a neighbourhood, is understood and treated as a brand or a multidimensional construct, consisting of functional, emotional, relational and strategic elements that collectively generate a unique set of associations with the place in the public mind (Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2005).

In the literature, however, distinct trends of discussion have emerged and not all adopt this view (Kavaratzis, 2005). The subject of place branding is indeed a complex subject and those trends represent the various aspects that bring about this complexity.

a) Place of Origin Branding (e.g. Kotler and Gertner, 2002; Papadopoulos and Heslop, 2002). This trend has developed within the marketing discipline and has grown to a large body of publications. It concerns the usage of the place of origin in branding a product. Using the qualities, images and, in most cases, stereotypes of the place and the people living in that place to brand a product that is produced in that place is considered an effective strategy. In essence though, it has little to do with the concept of place branding. Interesting as it may be (and useful for product marketing), this practice does not constitute a place branding strategy, in the sense that it can not be considered a place management strategy.

b) Nation Branding (e.g. van Ham, 2001; Gilmore, 2001; Anholt, 2002; 2007). This trend has also developed within the marketing discipline and especially within the circles of marketing consultants, who act as advisors

to national governments, that have realized the potential advantages of branding their country but do not have the knowledge and skills necessary to design and implement branding campaigns and strategies. The interest lies usually in the positive effects of branding the nation for the benefit of tourism development and the attraction of foreign investment. The topic has grown considerably, so that some commentators propose that the whole foreign affairs policy of the country should be thought of as a branding exercise. A growing number of researchers are examining the potential and suitability of branding nations (e.g. O'Shaughnessy and O'Shaughnessy, 2000) or specific methods and cases (e.g. Endzina and Luneva, 2004; Gilmore, 2001).

c) Destination Branding (e.g. Brent-Ritchie and Ritchie, 1998; Morgan et al., 2002). Perhaps the most developed in theory and most used in practice trend within place branding has been the investigation of the role of branding in the marketing of tourism destinations. Starting, arguably, from the realization that destinations are visited because of their prior images, and they are consumed based on a first-hand comparison of those images with the reality faced in the destination itself, this trend has offered much to the theory of place branding. The largest part, at least of the theoretical development in this field comes from Hankinson (2001; 2004a; 2007). Starting from his belief that 'as yet no general theoretical framework exists to underpin the development of place brands apart from classical, product-based branding theory' (Hankinson, 2004a:110), he provides a refined framework for understanding cities as brands even if focusing on cities mainly as tourism destinations. Brent-Ritchie and Ritchie (1998) recognize that a destination brand has the potential to play a coordinating role 'for a broad range of community development efforts' (p. 19), and stress the need for other agencies to agree with branding the destination, in this way realizing that destination branding is only part of the whole branding effort of any place.

d) Culture/Entertainment Branding (e.g. Evans, 2003; Greenberg, 2003; Hannigan, 2004). Another interesting and steadily growing trend has been the examination of the effects of cultural and entertainment branding on the physical, economic and, sometimes, social environment of cities. Widely applied in cities all over the world, this cultural branding owes its development to the growing importance of the cultural, leisure and entertainment industries within the contemporary economy, as much for tourists and other visitors, as for the local population. At the same time, attempts to incorporate this trend in planning the city (e.g. Evans, 2001; Ashworth, 2004) and the increased importance of image-based industries and the people these employ (Florida, 2002) are reinforcing the processes involved in this form of place branding. Connected with this trend, one

can identify a more recent discussion, especially among urban designers, on the effects of high-profile buildings on the city's image and the use of such buildings and other 'landmarks' in general in the city's promotion.

e) Integrated Place Branding A final trend in the literature can be found in a number of articles that try to discuss the possibilities of using branding as an approach to integrate, guide and focus place management. Borrowing from the techniques and ideas developed within general branding, and especially the advent of the increasingly popular concept of corporate branding, these articles discuss the appropriateness of central branding concepts for place branding (Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2005) and attempt to either provide a general framework for developing and managing place brands (Hankinson, 2004a; 2007; Kavaratzis, 2004; 2009) or examine the suitability of specific branding tools for city branding (Trueman et al., 2004). This last trend is characterized by the attempt to implement the concept of corporate branding and specific methodologies developed in this field in place branding (Rainisto, 2003; Trueman et al., 2004; Hankinson, 2007; Kavaratzis, 2009).

The above distinctions cannot be exhaustive, especially since the literature on place branding is steadily growing together with the number of international conferences and special issues in academic journals devoted to the topic. The field has even seen the launching of three specialized journals in the last five years (*Place Branding and Public Diplomacy*, the *Journal of Place Management and Development* and the *Journal of Town and City Management*). All the above approaches and most of the articles published, despite their varying suggestions and focus, have one thing in common: they make arguments for the implementation of branding within place management. These arguments are rooted in the assumption that, in essence, people 'understand' cities in the same way as brands (Ashworth and Kavaratzis, 2009). It is in peoples' minds that the city takes form through the processing of perceptions and images about the city. This process is the same as that followed in the formation of images of other entities like products or corporations, which have long been managed as brands. Extending this assumption raises the argument that the best way to attempt to influence peoples' perceptions and images about cities must be similar to the way that businesses have been successfully attempting the same for their products, namely branding. The above assumptions are, of course, subject to scrutiny as is found in the academic literature on place and city branding (e.g. Kavaratzis and Ashworth, 2005; Freire, 2005).

Each of the trends mentioned above has made its contribution towards a general understanding of the phenomenon of place branding and has proven its usefulness for specific fields of action. This variety in approaches

to place branding, coupled with several practical developments in cities around the world that interpret concepts in their own way and adopt their own approach, has lead to a certainly useful and exciting discussion but, at the same time, problematic development of place branding theory and practice. There are several fundamental questions that remain unanswered and are overlooked (deliberately or not) in the study and practice of branding nations, regions and cities. First of all there still seems to be no general agreement as to how to understand place branding and how this differs from place marketing or even simply promotion. The terms are still often used interchangeably (Skinner, 2008; Kalandides and Kavaratzis, 2009). Is place branding part of place marketing or the other way around? Is place branding (or place marketing for that matter) a strategic orientation or a tactical practice? Secondly, the non-geographical thinking of many commentators and practitioners who work in the field has lead to confusion in terms of the social and spatial implications of place branding. Questions of place-scale, place-function and place-identity should come to the foreground. Thirdly, all these questions mentioned above seem to interest researchers in particular fields, but are secondary for practitioners of city marketing. Practitioners need fast, easy answers, which theoreticians cannot offer; or when they do, these answers seem to have the quality of recipes or toolkits (Kalandides and Kavaratzis, 2009). All those might lead sceptics to an essential question: is place branding effective or even useful? To even tackle this question, there is a need to create a common body of knowledge and vocabulary among different disciplines working in the field.

This book is an attempt to contribute towards that ambition. The chapters included in the book, separately and collectively, set out to demonstrate that branding needs to be thought of as a continuous process interlinked with all marketing efforts and with the whole planning exercise. Place branding can be the means both for achieving competitive advantage in order to increase inward investment and tourism, but also the means for achieving community development, reinforcing local identity and identification of the citizens with their city and activating all social forces to avoid social exclusion and unrest. This is the underlying principle of all chapters presented here and this principle guides the theoretical suggestions, the evaluation of specific cases and the concluding section of the book.

PLACE BRANDING IN THIS BOOK

Although the topic of place branding has attracted the interest of commentators from several academic disciplines, its origins lie in marketing

science. It is in essence only the application of marketing to a special sort of product, namely places. Most of the rest of this book is concerned with the ramifications and implications of that application. Thus although most chapters examine how place marketing is a distinctive form of marketing, it is salutary at the outset to examine the opposite proposition. Indeed, the underlying argument of the first chapter by Hankinson is that the lack of an overarching comprehensive theory as repeatedly noted in the literature (e.g. Kavaratzis, 2005; Skinner, 2008) and the resulting lack of precision in terminology, is largely a consequence of the over-hasty adoption of terms and techniques from marketing, in order to serve new purposes, divorced from their conceptual origins in marketing. To remedy this, the chapter provides a comprehensive and thorough review of the relevant literature derived from marketing as the 'mother' discipline. The author traces the beginning of place branding studies in the literature on place images and place promotion, in an attempt to stem the tendency of place branding to develop separately from mainstream marketing literature. The contribution of each relevant discipline is highlighted with the intention of providing a basis for generating future research. Particularly useful to the readers of this book is the description of the evolution of classical product branding and its relevance to places. The author also outlines currently developing areas within mainstream marketing that could or should contribute to our knowledge and understanding of place branding. Such areas include particularly the burgeoning field of services marketing and the notion of corporate rather than specific product branding.

This recently investigated idea of corporate-level marketing is an issue taken further in Chapter 3 by Kavaratzis, where the corporate branding literature is examined in a search for relevant concepts and tools. The main contention is that corporate level marketing has brought marketing theories closer than ever before to the peculiarities and needs of places. The chapter starts with an overview of corporations as entities that need to be marketed and branded and goes on to assess the similarities between corporate and place branding. A particularly useful contribution of the chapter is the comparison of several place branding frameworks found in the literature and the outline of their commonalities and differences in an attempt to provide the basis for an integration, which this book examines further in the last chapter.

One of the major issues surrounding the conceptualization of place branding is the question whether, and to what extent, the place's brand can be based on the place's identity, which raises the ever-present question, 'whose identity?' Similarly, is place branding simply another form of image creation and projection? The chapter (4) by Deffner and Metaxas attempts to delineate the differences between brand, identity and image

and their role in place branding. The two cases examined in the chapter, namely Nea Ionia, Magnesia, Greece and Pafos, Cyprus, demonstrate the not unfamiliar struggle of places to find a balance between the 'old', well-established traditional character and the 'new', sought-after character and the ways in which the effort to find this balance determines the setting of branding goals and the processes that occur. The chapter starts from the need for competitiveness and describes the process of creating and communicating place brands based on the place's vision for the future and its distinctive characteristics. The focus of the chapter lies on culture and tourism, broadly defined in terms of their contribution to and reflection of identity, although it highlights the need for the agreement of local communities, particularly evident in the case of Pafos.

A frequently raised criticism against place marketing (and its derivative place branding) is that it tends, by its nature, to project an overly positive image of the place, disregarding (or even camouflaging) negative aspects that do not contribute or even contradict the elements being showcased. In other words it is argued that it is intrinsically in the nature of place marketing to exacerbate the gaps between projected image and experienced reality. The chapter by Mateo and Seisdedos (5) deals with this issue, albeit from an opposite angle. The core question they pose is what happens when a place (a city in this case) does not have the image that reality suggests it deserves? In their chapter the authors discuss Madrid's efforts to close the gap between perception and reality, arguing that the city indeed is deserving of a stronger international image in comparison with its competitors. The chapter describes the move from mass (and largely untargeted) marketing to targeting specific segments and the decision to establish a network of allies that would plan strategic initiatives designed to improve Madrid's international positioning. As the chapter demonstrates, Madrid has chosen several tools to achieve this improvement, which the authors call 'a new generation of city marketing tools'. These focus on building partnerships and include several interesting propositions such as place-product co-branding, the British Council's Open Cities programme and a distinct focus on Madrid's relations to Asia. The authors, although approving the goals and techniques, are rather sceptical about the seemingly ad-hoc nature of those partnerships as well as the city's apparent failure to implement more obvious and commonsense practices.

Place images are examined further in the chapter (6) by Bellini, Loffredo and Pasquinelli with their evocative and engaging analysis of the images of Tuscany. The authors remind us of the often forgotten fact that place branding is a highly political process and they demonstrate how the communication of place images is in many cases used to form and force through policy agendas, particularly in an effort to 'control representations of the

past, present and future' of places. The focus of the chapter is on 'other Tuscany's' whether elsewhere (places in and outside Italy that present themselves as the new Tuscany – only better) or within the region (areas that show a divergence from the region's overall image). Of particular interest is the authors' assessment of the problems emanating from a particularly strong image developed for the needs of the tourism industry. As demonstrated in the case of Tuscany, a strong, positive tourism image may prevent the emergence of other images that would reflect the visions of other sectors and would fulfil the need for more dynamic future prospects for the region. In other words, the chapter demonstrates how images of the same region may compete against each other, thus highlighting the complexities involved in the place branding endeavour. The inertia of established stereotypes and the implicit goals of policy-making are only two of the factors that deem place branding a process of excluding as much as including; a process of legitimizing already stagnant development goals as much as supporting alternative opportunities and models of development. The place brand inevitably interacts with the place's constantly changing identities held by insiders and outsiders. Is it then desirable or even possible to develop stable and consistent place brands, serving the multiple goals of heterogeneous regions?

The interaction between brands and territorial identities is also examined in the chapter (7) by Huertas, Morgan and Pritchard but from a different perspective. The chapter centres on an in-depth analysis of two regional brands: Wales and Catalonia. The analysis discloses the ways in which identities derived from a use of history are influencing both brand-building efforts and brand perceptions in the two regions. Despite the focus on destination branding, the chapter highlights the need for the destination brand to be rooted in a more-encompassing place brand. The authors discuss one of the many unresolved issues in place brand management, namely branding at different spatial scales, analysing the relationships between the two regional brands in their context of the 'higher' national brands (UK and Spain) as well as with 'lower' capital-city brands (Cardiff and Barcelona). In this way, the subject of brand-architecture and its relevance to place branding is brought into focus. The intriguing part of the chapter emerges from the choice of the two cases analysed and the ways that selective histories and their concomitant symbols and relics are used in place branding initiatives. The paramount importance of such fundamental issues as ethnic identification, cultural distinctiveness and, in both cases, a unique language is revealed as the chapter explores the identity-building aspects of place brands in what the authors call 'place-making'. This is a matter that goes deeper than the often claimed attempt to foster community-feelings and local pride through branding campaigns.

The underlying question is, can place branding respond to this challenge? Another interesting point raised by the authors is the confusion between the place brand (in this case the destination) and the brand of the tourism promotion agency; an issue also discussed later in the chapter (8) by Therkelsen et al.

A major difficulty of the place branding endeavour is that internal and external markets and audiences are both important and place branding is often called upon to cover the needs of both. Another difficulty or point of disagreement is whether the focus of branding lies on a symbolic representation of the landscape (see Chapter 12 by Warnaby and Medway), a physical ‘making’ of the landscape itself or upon some combination of the two. Therkelsen, Halkier and Jensen, in their chapters successfully integrate these two issues into their theoretical framework using contributions from the disciplines of marketing, urban studies and policy studies. Place branding is certainly about selling places but the nature of this selling is radically different from the common understanding of the term. Multiple offers, simultaneous selling to multiple audiences and other issues explained more fully elsewhere (see Ashworth and Voogd, 1990a) make it a unique type of selling and, therefore, a unique type of branding. The opportunity to create a sense of belonging – to build a place-based community – is inherent in the nature of place branding as is the need to pursue this opportunity. As the chapter clearly demonstrates, this has been, so far, a missed opportunity for the Danish city of Aalborg as, unfortunately, for many other such cities. The analysis included in the chapter, however, leads to several suggestions about the significance of the community-building goals of place branding and practical proposals about how to pursue them.

One particular community-building endeavour with relevance to many contemporary cities is examined in the chapter (9) by Trueman et al. It is the task of understanding ethnic minorities and attempting to take into account their cultural differences if place branding is to be effective. The chapter examines stakeholder involvement in policy-making and landscape or place-making interventions (see also Kavaratzis, 2009), particularly focusing on the Asian business community in the post-industrial city of Bradford, in Northern England. It investigates the networks of opinion-leaders, critical in any attempt to reach otherwise hard-to-reach communities. It involves utilizing several communication channels as well as developing significant relationships through trust-building efforts in order to enhance a local quality of life. As indicated in the chapter, there is often a mismatch between the agenda of city planners and the needs and objectives of local communities. The chapter highlights differences in the ways local people understand their immediate environment (their ‘neighbourhood’, as spatial and social entity) and the city planners’ approach to the

same environment (the same neighbourhood as one zone in a larger zoning system). One of the main findings of the authors' research is that this mutual lack of understanding often may lead to an absence of trust and even resentment by local communities towards top-down interventions by outside agencies.

The double target of internal and external audiences is an issue also tackled in the chapter (10) by Colomb and Kalandides, which includes a detailed and revealing review of place marketing and branding practices of the city of Berlin after the fall of the Wall. The review shows that creating a sense of local identity and civic pride is a common and admirable goal of place branding but it is the opportunities for participation and the ways in which these goals are pursued that determine the effectiveness of such internal place branding. The chapter includes a summary of the criticisms levelled against place marketing and place branding raising as devil's advocate many fundamental issues that underlie, implicitly or explicitly many chapters throughout this book. Particularly illuminating is the authors' evaluation of the recent branding campaign, '*be Berlin*', against the main points of this criticism. The analysis demonstrates that '*be Berlin*' can be considered a step forward, however haltingly, in terms of a more broad-based participation and, perhaps, what the authors would regard as a more 'honest' place branding. At least in its first stage, the campaign was directed at Berliners themselves, who featured centrally in the advertising, a positive and, unfortunately not common, feature of such promotional campaigns.

It is widely accepted that place marketing and branding have three main target groups: visitors, investors and residents. The first two are commonly believed to be more or less predictable in their behaviour towards places to visit or invest in. However, that is not the case with the place's residents and there is little conceptual or empirical research work addressing this group. If place branding is called upon to satisfy the needs and wants of residents, there is an obvious need to develop an understanding of how residents perceive their own place and consequently behave in it. What determines their satisfaction and in what ways do they attach to places? This is an issue directly addressed in the chapter (11) by Insch and Florek, which discusses the concept of resident place satisfaction and its importance for place branding. The authors, using contributions from environmental psychology, sociology and marketing, outline the factors that contribute to the satisfaction residents feel with their place of residence and that determine their attachment to their place. A framework to measure resident satisfaction is developed and is evaluated through the findings of the authors' own research on residents of the city of Dunedin, New Zealand. Such an analysis of the existing satisfaction, or as often the

absence of it, and especially its causes is clearly an essential precursor to branding campaigns directed at residents.

The search for differentiation is certainly one of the major forces that push places towards the use of branding techniques because places have long felt the need to present their distinctiveness to the outside world. The development of logos has thus far provided the main expression of this search for distinctiveness and uniqueness and it is the single branding element that has been applied with relative ease, if not always precision, within place management. The chapter (12) by Warnaby and Medway deals with place representation through logos that incorporate the natural or built environment. The authors use semiotic theories to examine logos as visual identification systems. They reveal the reasons why and the ways in which places use logos that are designed to enhance a place's unique identity, applying a novel and useful categorization of logos. The chapter explores several areas of tension. Logos may be assumed to simultaneously meet the needs of several different groups, separate agencies may use separate logos to promote their own field of activity within the same place and more broadly logos have an intrinsic capacity to develop 'associative property' between certain phenomena and the places within which these phenomena are located.

The search for distinctiveness and uniqueness has also found another expression in the efforts of places to associate themselves with certain personalities. This is the issue dealt with in the chapter (13) by Ashworth, which clarifies several matters that surround such practice and provides several well-known and less-known examples of personality association as an instrument of place branding. The logical, at first glance, assumption is that as people are unique individuals then places will acquire this character of uniqueness through this association with a nominated person. Whether real or fictional, whether actually at some point in time associated with the place or not, whether world renowned or locally significant, the life and work of specific people seems to provide an obvious tool for places to exploit in their branding efforts. The viability of this practice, however, as well as its relation with wider branding policies and the pitfalls involved are analysed and recommendations made. Issues of 'ownership' of such associations (as illustrated in the competition between several places for the ownership of Robin Hood or Santa Claus), the durability of the reputation of the personality selected and the implications of the place size on the use of personality association are all raised and exemplified in the chapter.

All the selected chapters were written by authors experienced in a particular academic approach or area of practical expertise. We hope that their synthesis of the issues raised in the book and the conclusions that can be

drawn from the cases investigated, will provide the basis for a better implementation of place branding, so that its potential as an extremely powerful tool of management, despite the drawbacks and difficulties discussed at length above, can at last be fully realized.